Nero exist right now? No. Does Lincoln exist right now? No. Does Elvis exist right now? No. None of them are on my current now-list. Does anyone born in the year 2300 or 3500 or 57000 exist now? No. Again, none of them are in my mind's-eye freeze-frame image, none of them are on my current time slice, and so, none of them are on my current now-list. Therefore, I say without hesitation that they do not currently exist. That is how I define reality at any given moment; it's an intuitive approach that most of us use, often implicitly, when thinking about existence.

I will make use of this conception below, but be aware of one tricky point. A now-list—reality in this way of thinking—is a funny thing. Nothing you see right *now* belongs on your now-list, because it takes time for light to reach your eyes. Anything you see right *now* has already happened. You are not seeing the words on this page as they are now; instead, if you are holding the book a foot from your face, you are seeing them as they were a billionth of a second ago. If you look out across an average room, you are seeing things as they were some 10 billionths to 20 billionths of a second ago; if you look across the Grand Canyon, you are seeing the other side as it was about one ten-thousandth of a second ago; if you look at the moon, you are seeing it as it was a second and a half ago; for the sun, you see it as it was about eight minutes ago; for stars visible to the naked eye, you see them as they were from roughly a few years ago to 10,000 years ago. Curiously, then, although a mental freeze-frame image captures our sense of reality, our intuitive sense of "what's out there," it consists of events that we can't experience, or affect, or even record right now. Instead, an actual now-list can be compiled only after the fact. If you know how far away something is, you can determine when it emitted the light you see *now* and so you can determine on which of your time slices it belongs—on which already past now-list it should be recorded. Nevertheless, and this is the main point, as we use this information to compile the now-list for any given moment, continually updating it as we receive light from ever more distant sources, the things that are listed are the things that we intuitively believe existed at that moment.

Remarkably, this seemingly straightforward way of thinking leads to an unexpectedly expansive conception of reality. You see, according to Newton's absolute space and absolute time, everyone's freeze-frame